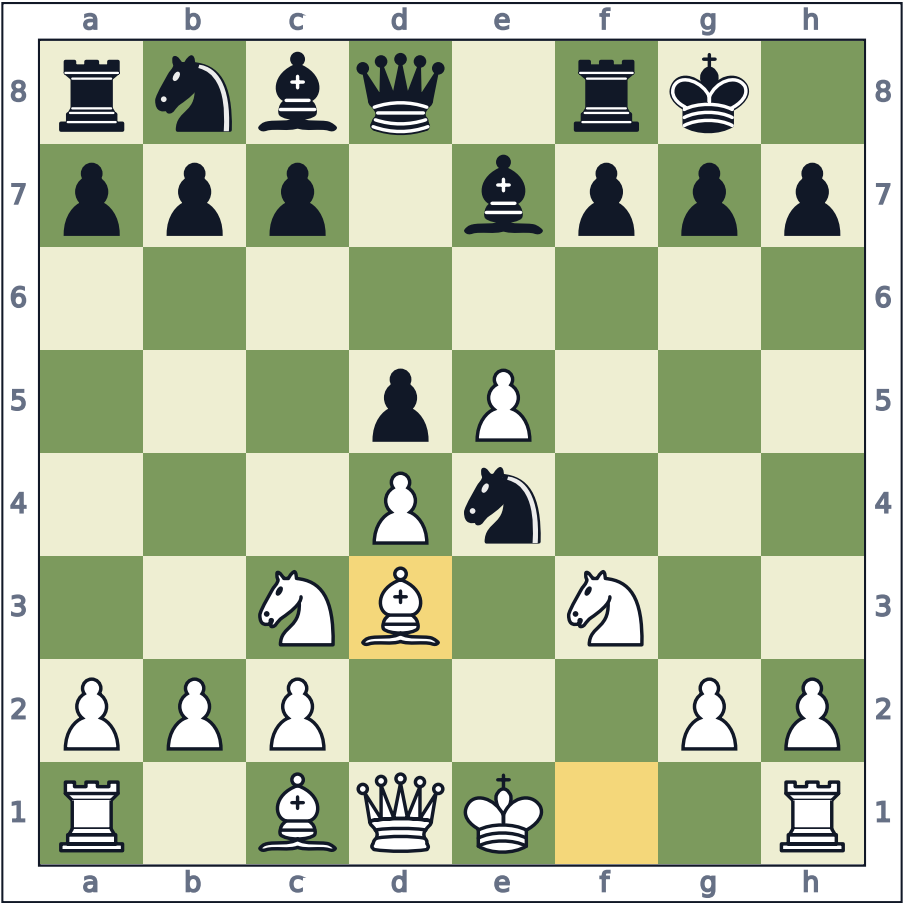


Vienna Game

A ground-up visual course for practical play



Core route position - gold marks the last move

WHITE FOCUS

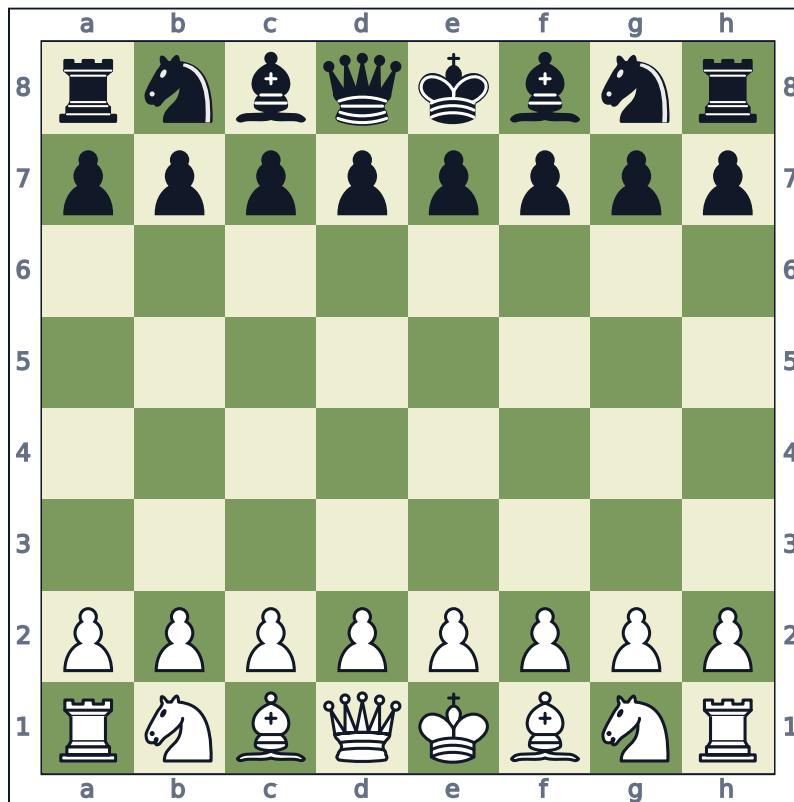
OPENING IDENTITY

Flexible development with the option of a fast f-pawn attack.

ORIENTATION

Ground zero: read the board and the moves

White starts from ranks 1-2; Black starts from ranks 7-8. Files run a through h. Each lesson highlights the last move in gold so your eyes connect notation to the board.



Starting position - White to move

HOW ALGEBRAIC NOTATION WORKS

Nf3 means a knight moves to f3. B means bishop, R rook, Q queen, K king; pawns use only the destination square. An x means capture, + means check, and O-O means kingside castling.

YOUR FIRST ANCHOR

Say the first moves aloud, then point to every destination square:

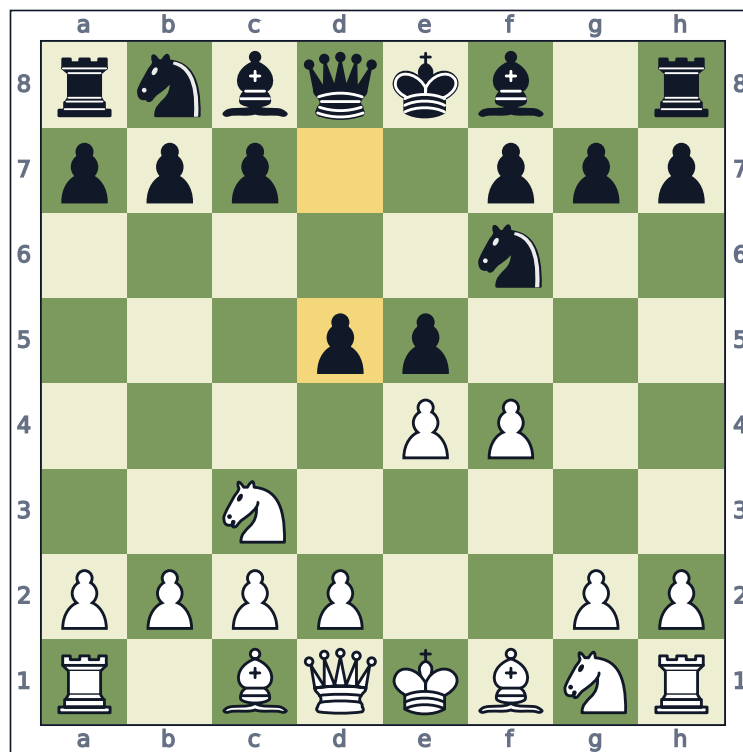
1. e4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. f4 d5

Course promise: Flank pressure works because the center is supported.

MOVES 1-3

Lesson 1: the first conversation

1. e4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. f4 d5



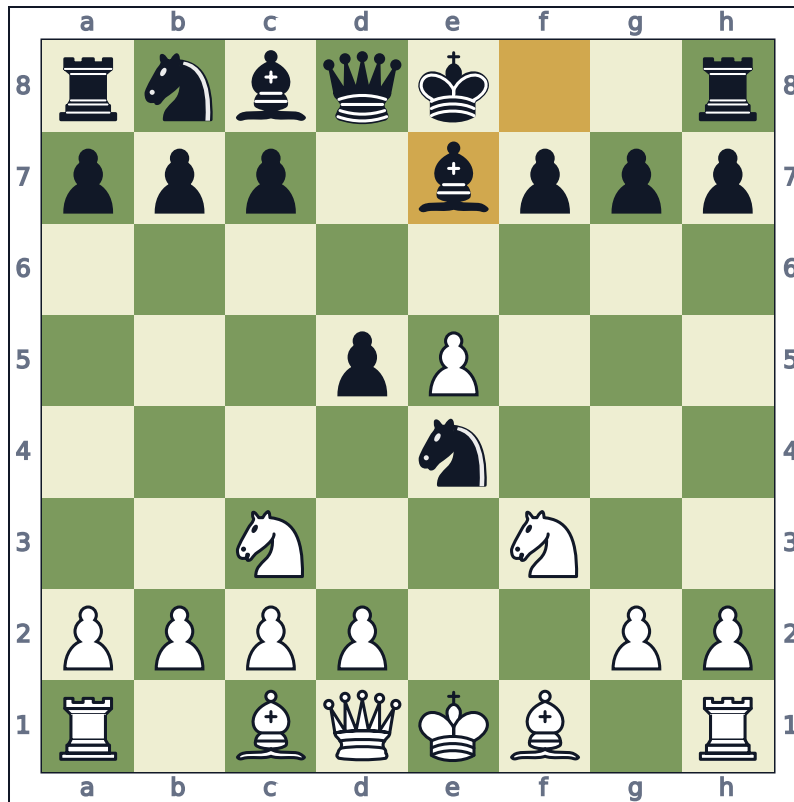
After 3. f4 d5

- 1. e4 - Claims or challenges central space and opens a line for a piece.
- 1... e5 - Claims or challenges central space and opens a line for a piece.
- 2. Nc3 - Develops a knight toward the center and increases control of key central squares.
- 2... Nf6 - Develops a knight toward the center and increases control of key central squares.
- 3. f4 - Creates a lever against the center or supports a coming break.
- 3... d5 - Claims or challenges central space and opens a line for a piece.

DEVELOPMENT

Lesson 2: build the core position

1. e4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. f4 d5 4. fxe5 Nxe4 5. Nf3 Be7



White to move

WHAT THE PIECES ARE BUILDING

Flexible development with the option of a fast f-pawn attack.

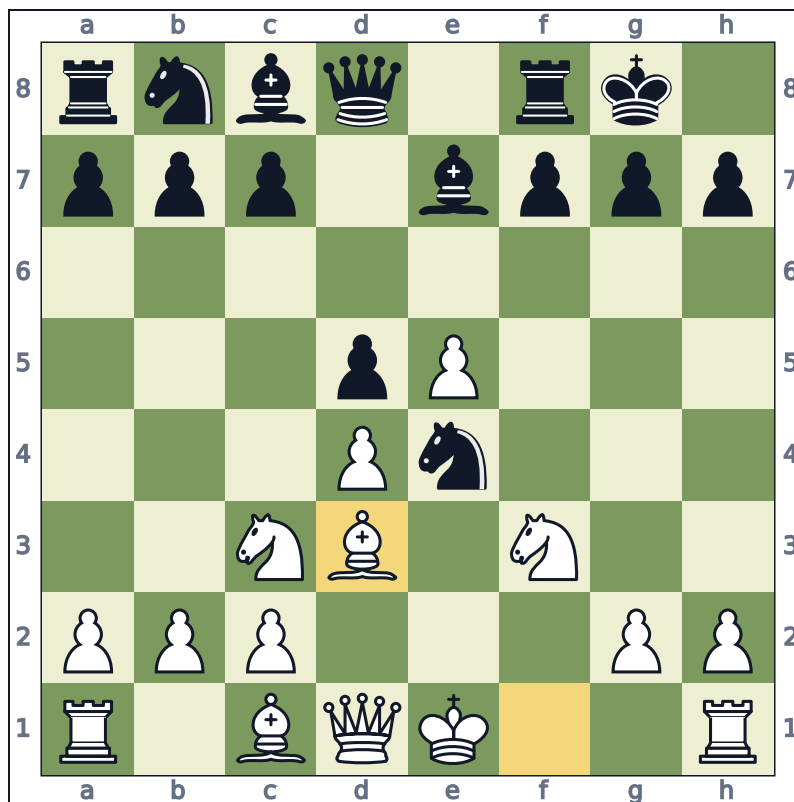
BEGINNER CHECKPOINT

Before copying the next move, ask: Is my king safe? Which piece is still at home? What changed in the center? Which pawn break is each side preparing?

CORE LINE

Lesson 3: complete the main route

1. e4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. f4 d5 4. fxe5 Nxe4 5. Nf3 Be7 6. d4 O-O 7. Bd3



Core position - now plans matter more than memorized moves

DO NOT MEMORIZE BLINDLY

The route is a model, not a forced script. Its job is to teach this relationship: Flexible development with the option of a fast f-pawn attack. If the opponent deviates, preserve the same priorities until a concrete tactic changes them.



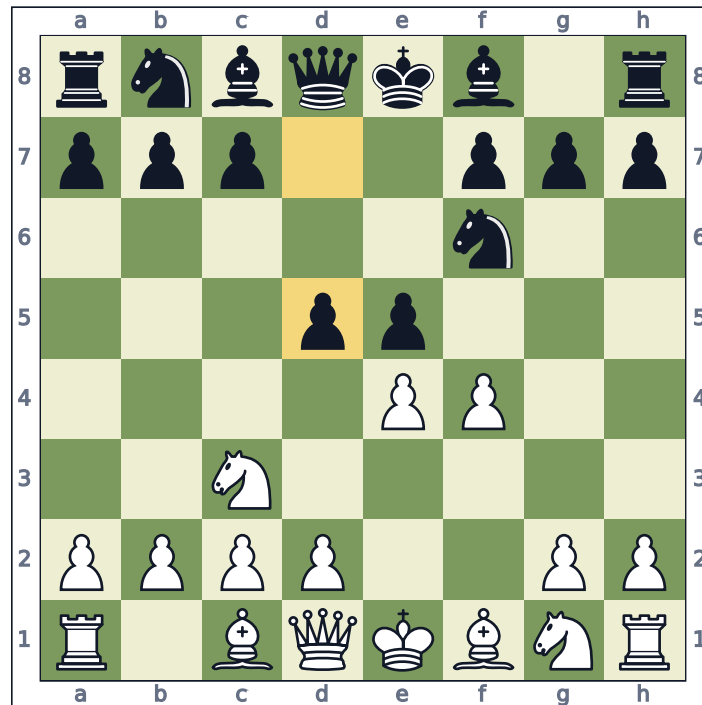
Support e4, use f4 to challenge e5, and open lines only with pieces ready.

Counter in the center with ...d5 and make White prove the kingside expansion is safe.

White's f4 is the signature break; Black's ...d5 is the principled reply.

CALCULATION

Tactical literacy: what can suddenly change



Pause here - White to move

THEME

The e4-knight can be attacked, but tactical exchanges on c3 and e5 must be calculated first.

COMMON BEGINNER ERROR

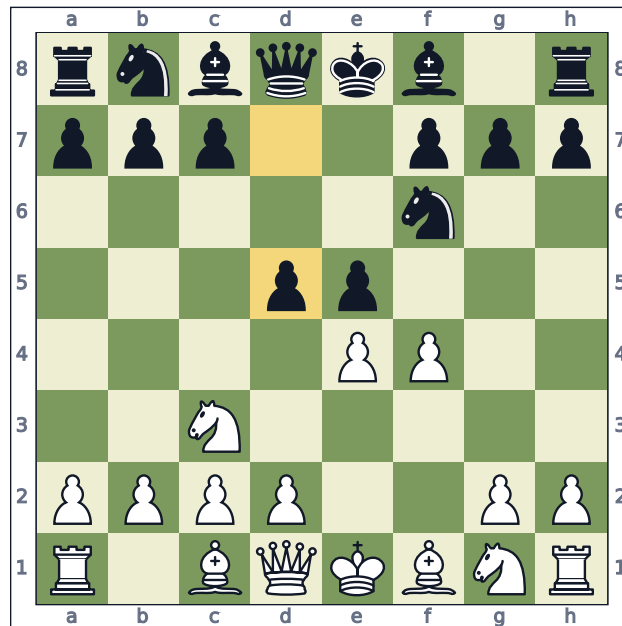
Playing f4, f5, and g4 without developing or checking the center.

THREE-SECOND SAFETY SCAN

1. Checks against both kings. 2. Captures in the center. 3. Threats against loose or pinned pieces.

ADAPTATION

Decision tree: when the opponent leaves the route



A branch point - principles are your map

1. If the center stays fluid

Finish development and keep the opening identity in view: Flexible development with the option of a fast f-pawn attack.

2. If the center closes

Use the pawn-chain direction. Attack the base before making wing moves that cannot be supported.

3. If the center opens

Prioritize king safety, active pieces, and checks or captures before slow pawn moves.

4. If nothing is forced

Return to the planned lever: White's f4 is the signature break; Black's ...d5 is the principled reply.

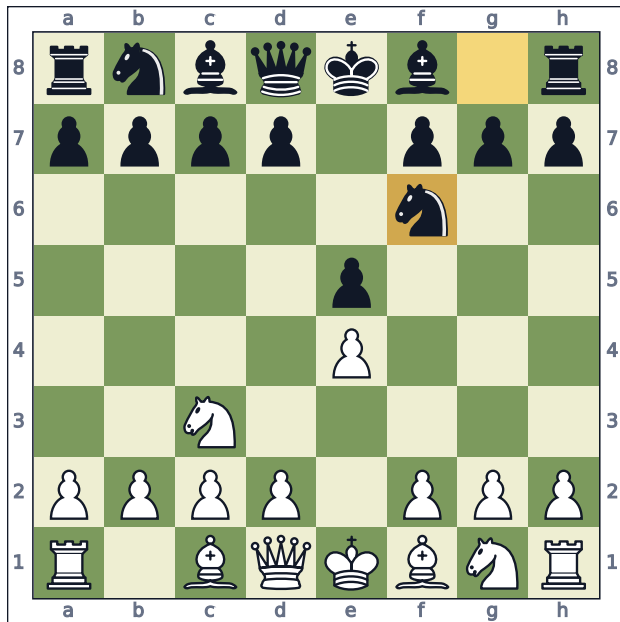
MEMORY SENTENCE

Flank pressure works because the center is supported.

ACTIVE RECALL

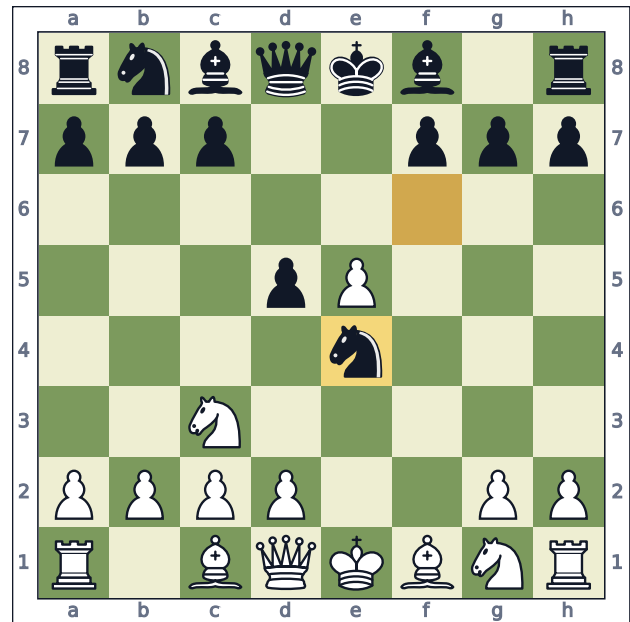
Recall test: answer before you turn the page

POSITION A



White to move

POSITION B



White to move

- A1. What is the next route move for White?
- A2. What opening problem does that move solve?
- B1. What is the next route move for White?
- B2. Name one plan for White and one plan for Black.
- C. State the thematic pawn break without looking back.

SCORING

5/5: replay from memory. 3-4/5: review Lessons 3 and 6. 0-2/5: return to Lesson 1 and rebuild the route slowly.

RETENTION

Answer key and a 14-day practice loop

POSITION A

Next route move: f4. Explain it using development, center, king safety, or a direct tactical need.

POSITION B

Next route move: Nf3. Then compare the position with the final core board.

PLAN AND BREAK ANSWERS

White: Support e4, use f4 to challenge e5, and open lines only with pieces ready. Black: Counter in the center with ...d5 and make White prove the kingside expansion is safe. Lever: White's f4 is the signature break; Black's ...d5 is the principled reply.

14-DAY LOOP

- Days 1-2: replay the first three moves from both sides and name each move's job.
- Days 3-4: build the core position from memory; correct the first error, then restart.
- Days 5-6: say White's plan, Black's plan, and the pawn break without a board.
- Day 7: take the recall test. Record the score; do not count lucky guesses.
- Days 8-10: play three slow practice games, starting from the core position if possible.
- Days 11-13: review only mistakes and deviations that actually occurred in your games.
- Day 14: retake the test and write a one-sentence opening rule in your own words.